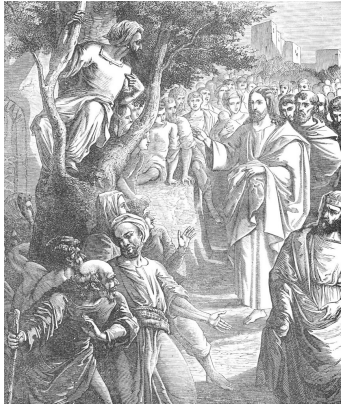


The Biblical usage of the words “father”, “son”, “mother”, “daughter”, “brother”, “sister”, and “begat” differs slightly from how we may use those words today in that it does not always refer to a *direct* relative of an individual. Instead, those words can refer to both direct and in-direct relatives of an individual.



Luke 19:8-10

⁸ And Zacchaeus stood, and said unto the Lord; Behold, Lord, the half of my goods I give to the poor; and if I have taken any thing from any man by false accusation, I restore *him* fourfold.

⁹ And Jesus said unto him, **This day is salvation come to this house, forsomuch as he also is a son of Abraham.**

¹⁰ **For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost.**

- Jesus' ministry began around 30AD and it lasted roughly 3 years and Abraham was born around 1996BC.
- Zacchaeus is a *descendant* of Abraham (Abraham is his ancestor).

Matthew 3:1-9

¹ In those days came John the Baptist, preaching in the wilderness of Judaea,

² And saying, Repent ye: for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.

³ For this is he that was spoken of by the prophet Esaias, saying, The voice of one crying in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make his paths straight.

⁴ And the same John had his raiment of camel's hair, and a leathern girdle about his loins; and his meat was locusts and wild honey.

⁵ Then went out to him Jerusalem, and all Judaea, and all the region round about Jordan,

⁶ And were baptized of him in Jordan, confessing their sins.

⁷ But when he saw many of the Pharisees and Sadducees come to his baptism, he said unto them, O generation of vipers, who hath warned you to flee from the wrath to come?

⁸ Bring forth therefore fruits meet for repentance:

⁹ And think not to say within yourselves, **We have Abraham to *our* father:** for I say unto you, that God is able of these stones to raise up children unto Abraham.



- When John the baptist was preaching and baptizing in the Judaeian wilderness many people of the sects of Pharisees and Sadducees came to him.
- We know from Jesus' ministry and verses such as Romans 1:16 that the gospel message was to go out to the Jews first (Abraham's *descendants*).
- The Pharisees and Sadducees that came out to visit John were *descendants* of Abraham.
- Abraham was born roughly 2,026 years before this event so he couldn't possibly have been their *direct* father as we might use the word today.
- John's warning to the Pharisees and Sadducees speaks to the fact that being a *descendant* of Abraham is not sufficient to save them from the wrath of God (John 1:13 - "...not of blood...").

Matthew 1:16

And Jacob begat Joseph the husband of Mary, of whom was born Jesus, who is called Christ.



- Jacob begat Joseph.
-

Luke 3:23

And Jesus himself began to be about thirty years of age, being (as was supposed) the son of Joseph, which was *the son of Heli*,

- Joseph “the son of Heli”.
-

Matthew 1:20

But while he thought on these things, behold, the angel of the Lord appeared unto him in a dream, saying, Joseph, thou *son of David*, fear not to take unto thee Mary thy wife: for that which is conceived in her is of the Holy Ghost.

- The angel of the Lord refers to Joseph as “thou son of David”.
-

Which one is Joseph's father? Jacob, Heli, or David? The answer is: all of them!

Luke 13:11-16

¹¹ And, behold, there was a woman which had a spirit of infirmity eighteen years, and was bowed together, and could in no wise lift up *herself*.

¹² And when Jesus saw her, he called *her to him*, and said unto her,

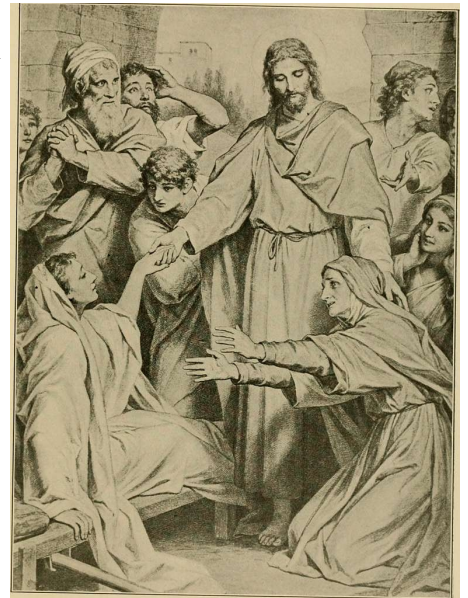
Woman, thou art loosed from thine infirmity.

¹³ And he laid *his* hands on her: and immediately she was made straight, and glorified God.

¹⁴ And the ruler of the synagogue answered with indignation, because that Jesus had healed on the sabbath day, and said unto the people, There are six days in which men ought to work: in them therefore come and be healed, and not on the sabbath day.

¹⁵ The Lord then answered him, and said, *Thou hypocrite, doth not each one of you on the sabbath loose his ox or his ass from the stall, and lead him away to watering?*

¹⁶ And ought not this woman, being a *daughter of Abraham*, whom Satan hath bound, lo, these eighteen years, be loosed from this bond on the sabbath day?



- The woman couldn't possibly have been a *direct* daughter of Abraham as we might use the word today because he was born ~2,000 years before these events. But, she definitely is a *descendant* of Abraham.

Let's find out how Maachah^{1Ki 15:2}/Michaiah^{2Ch 13:2} (likely grand-) daughter of Abishalom^{1Ki 15:2}/Absalom^{2Sa 3:3} is related to Asa king of Judah (the great-grandson^{1Ki 15:8, 14:31, 11:43, 2:46} of Solomon son of David^{2Sa 5:14}).

1 Kings 15:11-13

¹¹ And Asa did *that which* was right in the eyes of the LORD, as *did* David his father.

¹² And he took away the sodomites out of the land, and removed all the idols that his fathers had made.

¹³ And also Maachah his mother, even her he removed from *being* queen, because she had made an idol in a grove; and Asa destroyed her idol, and burnt *it* by the brook Kidron.

2 Chronicles 15:16

And also concerning Maachah the mother of Asa the king, he removed her from *being* queen, because she had made an idol in a grove: and Asa cut down her idol, and stamped *it*, and burnt *it* at the brook Kidron.

- Maachah mother of Asa. Seems easy right? But what about this next verse:
-

1 Kings 15:1-2

¹ Now in the eighteenth year of king Jeroboam the son of Nebat reigned Abijam over Judah.

² Three years reigned he in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Maachah, the daughter of Abishalom.

- Maachah mother of Abijam (AKA Abijah^{2Ch 11:20-22, 2Ch 12:16} and Abia^{1Ch 3:10, Mt 1:7}). So Maachah had two sons: one named Asa and the other named Abijam? Nope! Check out this next verse:
-

1 Kings 15:8

And Abijam slept with his fathers; and they buried him in the city of David: and Asa his son reigned in his stead.

- Abijam is Asa's father.

Wait...what? Since Abijam is Asa's father, how then could Maachah be the mother of both of them?

2 Chronicles 11:18-22

¹⁸ And Rehoboam took him Mahalath the daughter of Jerimoth the son of David to wife, *and* Abihail the daughter of Eliab the son of Jesse;

¹⁹ Which bare him children; Jeush, and Shamariah, and Zaham.

²⁰ And after her he took Maachah the daughter of Absalom; which bare him Abijah, and Attai, and Ziza, and Shelomith.

²¹ And Rehoboam loved Maachah the daughter of Absalom above all his wives and his concubines: (for he took eighteen wives, and threescore concubines; and begat twenty and eight sons, and threescore daughters.)

²² And Rehoboam made Abijah the son of Maachah the chief, *to be* ruler among his brethren: for *he thought* to make him king.

- Maachah is Rehoboam's wife and Maachah bare (*brought forth*) Abijah.
-

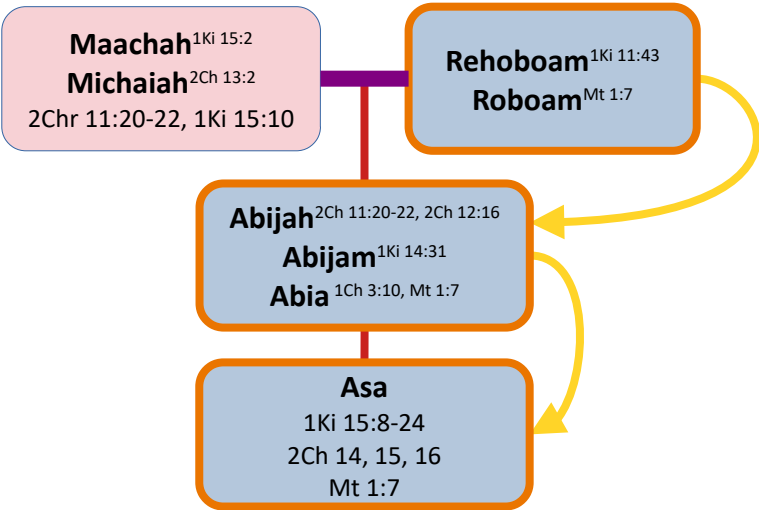
2 Chronicles 12:16

And Rehoboam slept with his fathers, and was buried in the city of David: and Abijah his son reigned in his stead.

- Rehoboam is Abijah's (AKA Abijam) father. Abijah became king *after* Rehoboam.

Now, let's put all the pieces together in a way that satisfies all of the conditions.

- Maachah is Rehoboam's wife and Maachah bare (*brought forth*) Abijah.
- Rehoboam is Abijah's (AKA Abijam) father.
 - Abijah became king *after* Rehoboam.
- Abijam (AKA Abijah) is Asa's father.
 - Asa became king *after* Abijam.
- Maachah is mother of both Asa and Abijam (AKA Abijah)



And with that, we can see that Maachah is what we would call Asa's *grandmother*.

“sister”	
Romans 16:1 I commend unto you Phebe our sister, which is a servant of the church which is at Cenchrea:	Paul refers to Phebe as <i>our</i> sister when addressing the church at Rome. Phebe is not <i>directly</i> the sister of both Paul and the entire church at Rome, instead she is a sister <i>in Christ</i>.
Numbers 6:5-9 ⁵ All the days of the vow of his separation there shall no razor come upon his head: until the days be fulfilled, in the which he separateth <i>himself</i> unto the LORD, he shall be holy, <i>and</i> shall let the locks of the hair of his head grow. ⁶ All the days that he separateth <i>himself</i> unto the LORD he shall come at no dead body. ⁷ He shall not make himself unclean for his father, or for his mother, for his brother, or for his sister, when they die: because the consecration of his God <i>is</i> upon his head. ⁸ All the days of his separation he <i>is</i> holy unto the LORD. ⁹ And if any man die very suddenly by him, and he hath defiled the head of his consecration; then he shall shave his head in the day of his cleansing, on the seventh day shall he shave it.	When the LORD gave Moses the instructions for a Nazarite vow, He made it very clear that coming into contact with <i>any</i> dead body was sin, it required atonement, and that the days of his separation before were lost due to the defiling of his separation (Numbers 6:1-12).

2 Kings 24:15-17

¹⁵ And he carried away Jehoiachin to Babylon, and the king's mother, and the king's wives, and his officers, and the mighty of the land, *those* carried he into captivity from Jerusalem to Babylon.

¹⁶ And all the men of might, *even* seven thousand, and craftsmen and smiths a thousand, all *that were* strong and apt for war, even them the king of Babylon brought captive to Babylon.

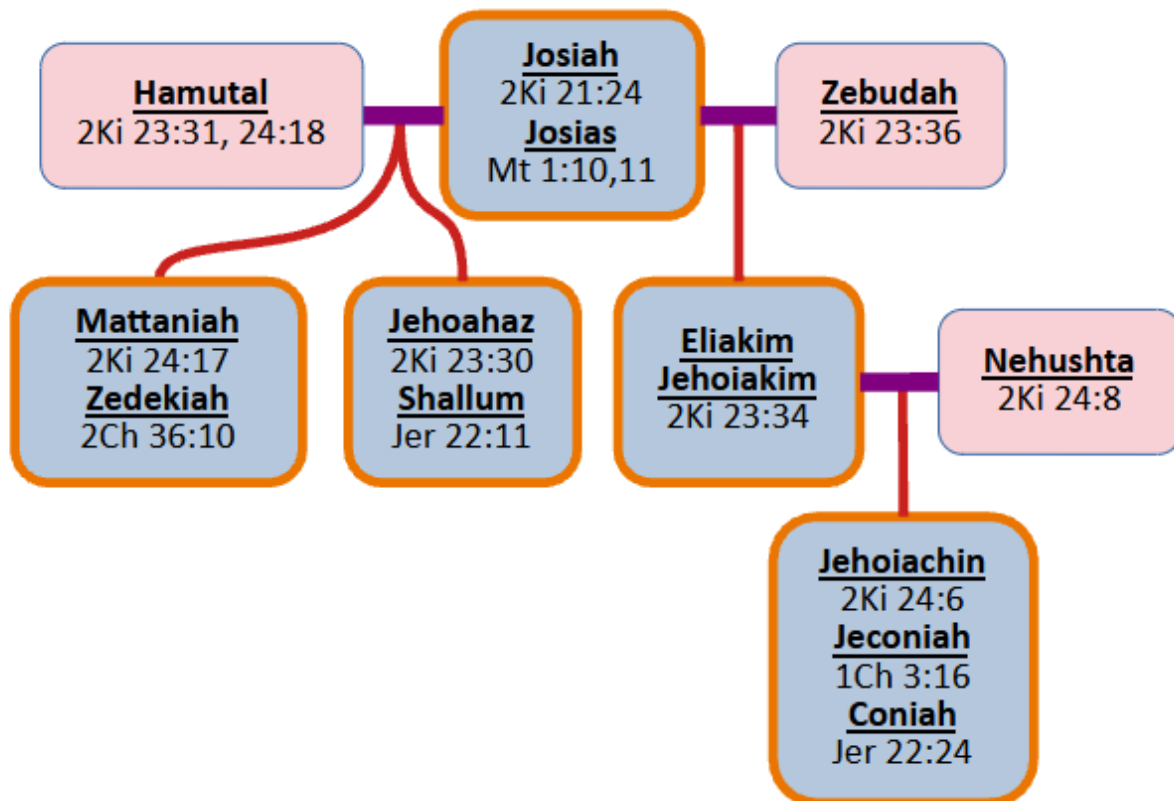
¹⁷ And the king of Babylon made Mattaniah **his father's brother** king in his stead, and changed his name to Zedekiah.

2 Chronicles 36:9-10

⁹ Jehoiachin *was* eight years old when he began to reign, and he reigned three months and ten days in Jerusalem: and he did *that which* was evil in the sight of the LORD.

¹⁰ And when the year was expired, king Nebuchadnezzar sent, and brought him to Babylon, with the goodly vessels of the house of the LORD, and made Zedekiah **his brother** king over Judah and Jerusalem.

- Mattaniah (AKA Zedekiah) is referred to both as Jehoiachin's brother and as his father's brother.
- Jehoiachin is removed from being king by Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon and his uncle (Mattaniah/Zedekiah) is made king instead.
- Refer to the scripture references in the chart below for more information.



This next example shows that when the Bible uses “begat” that it does not always mean a *direct* descendant. For a quick comparison to Matthew 1, refer to 1 Chronicles chapter 3.

Matthew 1:1-17 ¹ The book of the generation of Jesus Christ, the son of David, the son of Abraham. ² Abraham begat Isaac; and Isaac begat Jacob; and Jacob begat Judas and his brethren; ³ And Judas begat Phares and Zara of Thamar; and Phares begat Esrom; and Esrom begat Aram; ⁴ And Aram begat Aminadab; and Aminadab begat Naasson; and Naasson begat Salmon; ⁵ And Salmon begat Booz of Rachab; and Booz begat Obed of Ruth; and Obed begat Jesse; ⁶ And Jesse begat David the king; and David the king begat Solomon of her <i>that had been the wife</i> of Urias; ⁷ And Solomon begat Roboam; and Roboam begat Abia; and Abia begat Asa; ⁸ And Asa begat Josaphat; and Josaphat begat Joram; and Joram begat Ozias; ⁹ And Ozias begat Joatham; and Joatham begat Achaz; and Achaz begat Ezekias; ¹⁰ And Ezekias begat Manasses; and Manasses begat Amon; and Amon begat Josias; ¹¹ And Josias begat Jechonias and his brethren, about the time they were carried away to Babylon: ¹² And after they were brought to Babylon, Jechonias begat Salathiel; and Salathiel begat Zorobabel; ¹³ And Zorobabel begat Abiud; and Abiud begat Eliakim; and Eliakim begat Azor; ¹⁴ And Azor begat Sadoc; and Sadoc begat Achim; and Achim begat Eliud; ¹⁵ And Eliud begat Eleazar; and Eleazar begat Matthan; and Matthan begat Jacob; ¹⁶ And Jacob begat Joseph the husband of Mary, of whom was born Jesus, who is called Christ. ¹⁷ So all the generations from Abraham to David <i>are</i> fourteen generations; and from David until the carrying away into Babylon <i>are</i> fourteen generations; and from the carrying away into Babylon unto Christ <i>are</i> fourteen generations.	1. Abraham 2. Isaac 3. Jacob 4. Judas (Judah) Gen 46:12 5. Phares (Pharez) & Zara (Zerah) Gen 46:12 6. Esrom 7. Aram 8. Aminadab 9. Naasson 10. Salmon 11. Booz 12. Obed 13. Jesse 14. David ^{1Ch 3} 15. Solomon 16. Roboam 17. Abia 18. Asa 19. Josaphat (Jehoshaphat 1Ki 15:24) 20. Joram (Jehoram 2Ki 8:16) • Elder Ahaziah • Younger Ahaziah (Azariah/Jehoahaz/Azariah) • Joash (Jehoash) • Amaziah 21. Ozias (Azariah/Uzziah) 22. Joatham (Jotham) 23. Achaz 24. Ezekias (Hezekiah) 25. Manasses (Manasseh) 26. Amon 27. Josias (Josiah) • Jehoahaz • Eliakim/Jehoiakim 28. Jechonias (Elder Jehoichin/Jeconiah/Coniah) • Younger Jehoiachin (“co-regency” with the elder Jehoiachin and Jehoiakim Jer 36:30) 29. Salathiel (Shealtiel) 30. Zorobabel (Zerubbabel) ^{Ezr 3:2} 31. Abiud 32. Eliakim 33. Azor 34. Sadoc 35. Achim 36. Eliud 37. Eleazar 38. Matthan 39. Jacob 40. Joseph 41. Jesus
---	--

By studying the genealogies and succession of kings of Judah in 1st & 2nd Chronicles and 1st & 2nd Kings very carefully and then comparing them to Matthew 1 you’ll notice that 7 men that are called both sons and kings are not listed (some we know were not birth sons).

“children of / sons of / daughter of / man of / men of Belial” are unique phrases in that they are not a statement of ancestry or descent but instead they are a statement of character.	
Deuteronomy 13:13 <i>Certain men, the children of Belial, are gone out from among you, and have withdrawn the inhabitants of their city, saying, Let us go and serve other gods, which ye have not known;</i>	The children of Israel are instructed how to deal with cities whose inhabitants have been drawn away from God and into idolatry.
Judges 19 ²² Now as they were making their hearts merry, behold, the men of the city, certain sons of Belial, beset the house round about, <i>and</i> beat at the door, and spake to the master of the house, the old man, saying, Bring forth the man that came into thine house, <i>that we may know him.</i> ²³ And the man, the master of the house, went out unto them, and said unto them, Nay, my brethren, <i>nay</i>, I pray you, <i>do not so wickedly</i>; seeing that this man is come into mine house, <i>do not this folly.</i>	Wicked men attempt sodomy with a Levite who travels to retrieve his concubine that returned to her father’s house. Instead, they abuse the concubine all night until the morning.
1 Samuel 1:16 Count not thine handmaid for a daughter of Belial: for out of the abundance of my complaint and grief have I spoken hitherto.	Hannah speaking to Eli after he supposed that she was drunken
2 Samuel 16:7 And thus said Shimei when he cursed, Come out, come out, thou bloody man, and thou man of Belial:	Shimei cursing David
1 Kings 21:13 And there came in two men, children of Belial, and sat before him: and the men of Belial witnessed against him, <i>even</i> against Naboth, in the presence of the people, saying, Naboth did blaspheme God and the king. Then they carried him forth out of the city, and stoned him with stones, that he died.	False witnesses condemning Naboth
1 Samuel 10:26-27 ²⁶ And Saul also went home to Gibeah; and there went with him a band of men, whose hearts God had touched. ²⁷ But the children of Belial said, How shall this man save us? And they despised him, and brought him no presents. But he held his peace.	Gainsayers (contradicting, denying, opposing) against God (1Sa 9:16)
2 Corinthians 6:14-18 ¹⁴ Be ye not unequally yoked together with unbelievers: for what fellowship hath righteousness with unrighteousness? and what communion hath light with darkness? ¹⁵ And what concord hath Christ with Belial? or what part hath he that believeth with an infidel?	Unbelievers, unrighteous, darkness, infidel, idolatry, unclean
1 Samuel 1:3 And this man went up out of his city yearly to worship and to sacrifice unto the LORD of hosts in Shiloh. And the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, the priests of the LORD, <i>were</i> there.	
1 Samuel 2:12 Now the sons of Eli <i>were</i> sons of Belial; they knew not the LORD.	